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Inventor(s)	Lee; Eugene

Systems and methods for providing spatial awareness in virtual reality

Abstract

In one embodiment, a method includes rendering a partial passthrough mode that provides a partial view of a VR environment and a partial view of a real-world environment. The method can perform the rendering by one or both of: A) rendering at least a first portion of a partial view of the real-world environment at a first sharpness level and rendering at least a second portion of the partial view of the real-world environment at a second sharpness level lower than the first sharpness level, and/or B) rendering the partial view of the real-world environment at a size or sharpness level based on a determined position of the user between an inner boundary of one or more virtual boundaries and an outer boundary of the one or more virtual boundaries.

Inventors:	Lee; Eugene (Mountain View, CA)
Applicant:	Meta Platforms Technologies, LLC (Menlo Park, CA)
Family ID:	1000008779929
Assignee:	Meta Platforms Technologies, LLC (Menlo Park, CA)
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Primary Examiner: Brier; Jeffery A

Attorney, Agent or Firm: Potomac Law Group, PLLC

Background/Summary

CROSS-REFERENCE TO RELATED APPLICATION (1) This application is a continuation application of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 18/063,255, now U.S. Pat. No. 11,989,844, filed on Dec. 8, 2022 entitled “Systems And Methods For Providing Spatial Awareness In Virtual Reality,” which is a continuation of U.S. patent application Ser. No. 17/551,926, filed 15 Dec. 2021 “Systems And Methods For Providing Spatial Awareness In Virtual Reality,” now U.S. Pat. No. 11,704,879 issued on Jul. 18, 2023, which is a continuation under U.S. patent application Ser. No. 17/139,434, filed 31 Dec. 2020 entitled “Systems And Methods For Providing Spatial Awareness In Virtual Reality,” now U.S. Pat. No. 11,232,644 issued on Jan. 25, 2022, all of which are incorporated herein by reference.

TECHNICAL FIELD

(1) This disclosure generally relates to databases and file management within network environments, and in particular relates to determining spatial awareness in a virtual reality (VR) setting.

BACKGROUND

(2) Traditional methods of spatial awareness in VR settings require a user to define a boundary wall that represents the outer bounds of a safe boundary perimeter for the user to move around in. For example, the user can draw a line on the floor in a room as the boundary (e.g., for a room-scale VR setting) or have a computer system automatically defining a circular perimeter centered on a stationary sitting or standing user (e.g., for a stationary VR setting). As the user or the user's hands approaches the boundary, a virtual wall can appear to alert the user they are approaching the boundary. For room-scale VR users, the user may have a small room where the virtual wall constantly appears, frustrating the user experience and breaking the VR immersion. For stationary VR users, the user may constantly see the virtual wall as their head and/or hands move, causing some users to feel enclosed and claustrophobic. Further, in some situations, like if the user is move backwards out of the boundary, the virtual wall may not appear within the user's field of view until it is too late, risking injury to the user if they are moving too quickly.

SUMMARY OF PARTICULAR EMBODIMENTS

(3) In particular embodiments, a user of an immersive VR system may have their view of the real-world environment partially or fully occluded by the VR system, and thus risk running into or hitting real-world objects while immersed in a VR environment. Additionally, immersion in the VR environment may disorient the user as to their position and/or orientation in the real-world environment. That is, the user may forget where they were standing, or where furniture or other objects in their vicinity are. Thus, one technical challenge may include maintaining an immersive VR experience while also conveying spatial information about the real-world environment to a user immersed in the VR experience. Traditional methods of keeping the user safe and helping the user orient themselves in a VR environment include drawing of a virtual boundary, which may be a line drawn by a user that defines a safe zone for the user while they are in the VR experience. As the user approaches the boundary, a virtual boundary wall may appear or activate. The system can use the virtual boundary wall to alert the user where the virtual boundary is. For example, these virtual

boundary walls may have grid-like appearances corresponding to the line drawn by the user defining the virtual boundary. But these boundary walls can disrupt the immersion while in the VR environment, detracting from the user's experience. One solution presented by the embodiments disclosed herein to address the technical challenge of conveying spatial information about the real-world to the user may be to provide a "directional" passthrough view of the real-world environment within the VR environment as the user approaches the virtual boundary. The passthrough view may be considered "directional" in that the area and position of the passthrough view may be based on the user's relative movement and field of view in the VR environment. While in the directional passthrough view, the user can see where the virtual boundary (e.g., the virtual line drawn by the user) is, to help the user stay in the safe zone. A technical advantage of the embodiments may include providing the pose (e.g., position and orientation) of the user in the real-world environment, and providing spatial information by showing the user a quick glimpse of the real-world environment while maintaining the VR experience, providing the user with visual information that can help the user avoid objects outside of the boundary as well as help the user reorient themselves in the real-world environment. As an example and not by way of limitation, a user walking forward may be approaching a desk that lies outside of the virtual boundary. Without fully breaking the VR immersion, a portion of the user's field of view may transition from a rendering of the VR environment to a rendering of a directional passthrough view of the real-world environment (and accordingly, the desk that lies in the user's path) to help the user avoid running into the desk and to help the user reorient themselves in the middle of the VR boundary. Although this disclosure describes a method of providing spatial awareness in a VR setting using directional passthrough, this disclosure contemplates providing spatial awareness in a VR setting in any suitable manner.

(4) In particular embodiments, one or more computing systems may render, for one or more displays of a VR display device, a first output image of a VR environment based on a field of view of a user. The VR environment can comprise a virtual boundary corresponding to a real-world environment. The one or more computing systems can determine whether the user is approaching within a first threshold distance of the virtual boundary. The one or more computing systems can determine, responsive to the user approaching within the first threshold distance of the virtual boundary, a direction of movement and the field of view of the user. The one or more computing systems can access one or more images of the real-world environment captured by one or more cameras of the VR display device. The one or more computing systems can render, for the one or more displays of the VR display device, a second output image comprising a portion of the VR environment and a portion of a passthrough view of the real-world environment based on the accessed images. The portion of the passthrough view may be based on the determined direction of movement and the field of view of the user.

(5) Certain technical challenges exist for determining spatial awareness in a VR setting. One technical challenge may include conveying spatial information about the real-world environment and objects within the real-world environment to a user while the user is immersed in a VR experience. The solution presented by the embodiments disclosed herein to address this challenge may be to provide a quick glimpse via a directional passthrough view to the real-world environment so the user can ascertain where they are in the real-world environment. Another technical challenge may include maintaining the immersion of the VR experience while also providing the user with the necessary visual information to orient themselves in the virtual boundary. The solution presented by the embodiments disclosed herein to address this challenge may be to render an opaque, translucent, or otherwise outlined rendering of a real-world object in the VR environment which can alert the user to the presence of the real-world object, without significantly interrupting the VR experience.

(6) Certain embodiments disclosed herein may provide one or more technical advantages. A technical advantage of the embodiments may include providing spatial information by providing quick glimpse of the real-world environment through directional passthrough views of the real-

world environment while immersed in the VR environment, or providing outline renderings of real-world objects in the VR environment to alert the user of objects that may lie in their path without significantly disrupting the immersion of the VR experience. Another technical advantage of the embodiments may include providing spatial information by determining the optimal direction for the directional passthrough view, regardless of which direction the user is moving. Certain embodiments disclosed herein may provide none, some, or all of the above technical advantages. One or more other technical advantages may be readily apparent to one skilled in the art in view of the figures, descriptions, and claims of the present disclosure.

(7) The embodiments disclosed herein are only examples, and the scope of this disclosure is not limited to them. Particular embodiments may include all, some, or none of the components, elements, features, functions, operations, or steps of the embodiments disclosed herein.

Embodiments according to the invention are in particular disclosed in the attached claims directed to a method, a storage medium, a system and a computer program product, wherein any feature mentioned in one claim category, e.g. method, may be claimed in another claim category, e.g. system, as well. The dependencies or references back in the attached claims are chosen for formal reasons only. However any subject matter resulting from a deliberate reference back to any previous claims (in particular multiple dependencies) may be claimed as well, so that any combination of claims and the features thereof are disclosed and may be claimed regardless of the dependencies chosen in the attached claims. The subject-matter which may be claimed comprises not only the combinations of features as set out in the attached claims but also any other combination of features in the claims, wherein each feature mentioned in the claims may be combined with any other feature or combination of other features in the claims. Furthermore, any of the embodiments and features described or depicted herein may be claimed in a separate claim and/or in any combination with any embodiment or feature described or depicted herein or with any of the features of the attached claims.

Description

BRIEF DESCRIPTION OF THE DRAWINGS

- (1) FIG. 1A illustrates an example artificial reality system worn by a user, in accordance with particular embodiments.
- (2) FIG. 1B illustrates an example of a passthrough feature, in accordance with particular embodiments.
- (3) FIG. 1C illustrates a virtual reality system within a real-world environment.
- (4) FIG. 1D illustrates a perspective view of a passthrough view of the real-world environment within the virtual reality environment.
- (5) FIGS. 2A-2D illustrate top-down views of passthrough views of the real-world environment within the virtual reality environment.
- (6) FIGS. 3A-3D illustrates sample perspective views of the passthrough view of the real-world environment within the virtual reality environment, without an adjustment for the field of view.
- (7) FIGS. 4A-4D illustrates sample perspective views of the passthrough view of the real-world environment within the virtual reality environment, with an adjustment for the field of view.
- (8) FIG. 5A illustrates a sample perspective view of a compensation for the adjustment of the field of view.
- (9) FIGS. 5B-5C are graphs illustrating the percent compensation of transitions into passthrough views.
- (10) FIG. 6 illustrates a sample diagrammatic view of a user's vision.
- (11) FIG. 7 illustrates a perspective view of the user in a boundary space.
- (12) FIG. 8 illustrates a perspective view of an outline rendering view of a real-world object in the

virtual reality environment.

(13) FIG. 9 illustrates an example method for determining spatial awareness in a VR setting using a passthrough view.

(14) FIG. 10 illustrates an example network environment associated with a VR or social-networking system.

(15) FIG. 11 illustrates an example computer system.

DESCRIPTION OF EXAMPLE EMBODIMENTS

(16) In particular embodiments, a user of an immersive VR system (e.g., head-mounted VR goggles) may have their view of the real-world environment partially or fully occluded by the VR system, and thus risk running into or hitting real-world objects while immersed in a VR environment. Additionally, immersion in the VR environment may disorient the user as to their position and/or orientation in the real-world environment. That is, the user may forget where they were standing, or where furniture or other objects in their vicinity are. Thus, one technical challenge may include maintaining an immersive VR experience while also conveying spatial information about the real-world environment to a user immersed in the VR experience. Traditional methods of keeping the user safe and helping the user orient themselves in a VR environment include drawing of a virtual boundary, which may be a line drawn by a user that defines a safe zone for the user while they are in the VR experience. As the user approaches the boundary, a virtual boundary wall may appear or activate. The system can use the virtual boundary wall to alert the user where the virtual boundary is. For example, these virtual boundary walls may have grid-like appearances corresponding to the line drawn by the user defining the virtual boundary. But these boundary walls can disrupt the immersion while in the VR environment, detracting from the user's experience. One solution presented by the embodiments disclosed herein to address the technical challenge of conveying spatial information about the real-world to the user may be to provide a “directional” passthrough view of the real-world environment within the VR environment as the user approaches the virtual boundary. The passthrough view may be considered “directional” in that the area and position of the passthrough view may be based on the user's relative movement and field of view in the VR environment. While in the directional passthrough view, the user can see where the virtual boundary (e.g., the virtual line drawn by the user) is, to help the user stay in the safe zone. A technical advantage of the embodiments may include providing the pose (e.g., position and orientation) of the user in the real-world environment, and providing spatial information by showing the user a quick glimpse of the real-world environment while maintaining the VR experience, providing the user with visual information that can help the user avoid objects outside of the boundary as well as help the user reorient themselves in the real-world environment. As an example and not by way of limitation, a user walking forward may be approaching a desk that lies outside of the virtual boundary. Without fully breaking the VR immersion, a portion of the user's field of view may transition from a rendering of the VR environment to a rendering of a directional passthrough view of the real-world environment (and accordingly, the desk that lies in the user's path) to help the user avoid running into the desk and to help the user reorient themselves in the middle of the VR boundary. Although this disclosure describes a method of providing spatial awareness in a VR setting using directional passthrough, this disclosure contemplates providing spatial awareness in a VR setting in any suitable manner.

(17) FIG. 1A illustrates an example of a virtual reality system 50 worn by a user 102. In particular embodiments, the virtual reality system 50 may comprise a head-mounted VR display device 135, a controller 106, and a computing system 110. The VR display device 135 may be worn over the user's eyes and provide visual content to the user 102 through internal displays (not shown). The VR display device 135 may have two separate internal displays, one for each eye of the user 102 (single display devices are also possible). As illustrated in FIG. 1A, the VR display device 135 may completely cover the user's field of view. By being the exclusive provider of visual information to the user 102, the VR display device 135 achieves the goal of providing an immersive artificial-

reality experience. One consequence of this, however, is that the user **102** may not be able to see the physical (real-world) environment surrounding him, as his vision is shielded by the VR display device **135**. As such, the passthrough feature described herein may be technically advantageous for providing the user with real-time visual information about his physical surroundings.

(18) FIG. 1B illustrates an example of the passthrough feature. A user **102** may be wearing a VR display device **135**, immersed within a virtual reality environment. A real-world object **145** is in the physical environment surrounding the user **102**. However, due to the VR display device **135** blocking the vision of the user **102**, the user **102** is unable to directly see the real-world object **145**. To help the user perceive his physical surroundings while wearing the VR display device **135**, the passthrough feature captures information about the physical environment using, for example, the aforementioned external-facing cameras **105A-B**. The captured information may then be re-projected to the user **102** based on his viewpoints. In particular embodiments where the VR display device **135** has a right display **136A** for the user's right eye and a left display **136B** for the user's left eye, the virtual reality system **50** may individually render (1) a re-projected view **145A** of the physical environment for the right display **135A** based on a viewpoint of the user's right eye and (2) a re-projected view **145B** of the physical environment for the left display **135B** based on a viewpoint of the user's left eye.

(19) Referring again to FIG. 1A, the VR display device **135** may have external-facing cameras, such as the two forward-facing cameras **105A** and **105B** shown in FIG. 1A. While only two forward-facing cameras **105A-B** are shown, the VR display device **135** may have any number of cameras facing any direction (e.g., an upward-facing camera to capture the ceiling or room lighting, a downward-facing camera to capture a portion of the user's face and/or body, a backward-facing camera to capture a portion of what's behind the user, and/or an internal camera for capturing the user's eye gaze for eye-tracking purposes). The external-facing cameras may be configured to capture the physical environment around the user and may do so continuously to generate a sequence of frames (e.g., as a video). As previously explained, although images captured by the forward-facing cameras **105A-B** may be directly displayed to the user **102** via the VR display device **135**, doing so may not provide the user with an accurate view of the physical environment since the cameras **105A-B** cannot physically be located at the exact same location as the user's eyes. As such, the passthrough feature described herein may use a re-projection technique that generates a 3D representation of the physical environment and then renders images based on the 3D representation from the viewpoints of the user's eyes.

(20) The 3D representation may be generated based on depth measurements of physical objects observed by the cameras **105A-B**. Depth may be measured in a variety of ways. In particular embodiments, depth may be computed based on stereo images. For example, the two forward-facing cameras **105A-B** may share an overlapping field of view and be configured to capture images simultaneously. As a result, the same physical object may be captured by both cameras **105A-B** at the same time. For example, a particular feature of an object may appear at one pixel p.sub.A in the image captured by camera **105A**, and the same feature may appear at another pixel p.sub.B in the image captured by camera **105B**. As long as the depth measurement system knows that the two pixels correspond to the same feature, the virtual reality system **50** could use triangulation techniques to compute the depth of the observed feature. For example, based on the camera **105A**'s position within a 3D space and the pixel location of p.sub.A relative to the camera **105A**'s field of view, a line could be projected from the camera **105A** and through the pixel p.sub.A. A similar line could be projected from the other camera **105B** and through the pixel p.sub.B. Since both pixels are supposed to correspond to the same physical feature, the two lines should intersect. The two intersecting lines and an imaginary line drawn between the two cameras **105A** and **105B** form a triangle, which could be used to compute the distance of the observed feature from either camera **105A** or **105B** or a point in space where the observed feature is located.

(21) In particular embodiments, the pose (e.g., position and orientation) of the VR display device

135 within the environment may be needed. For example, in order to render the appropriate display for the user **102** while he is moving about in a virtual environment, the virtual reality system **50** may need to determine his position and orientation at any moment. Based on the pose of the VR display device, the virtual reality system **50** may further determine the viewpoint of either of the cameras **105A** and **105B** or either of the user's eyes. In particular embodiments, the VR display device **135** may be equipped with inertial-measurement units ("IMU"). The data generated by the IMU, along with the stereo imagery captured by the external-facing cameras **105A-B**, allow the virtual reality system **50** to compute the pose of the VR display device **135** using, for example, SLAM (simultaneous localization and mapping) or other suitable techniques.

(22) In particular embodiments, the virtual reality system **50** may further have one or more controllers **106** that enable the user **102** to provide inputs. The controller **106** may communicate with the VR display device **135** or a separate computing system **110** via a wireless or wired connection. The controller **106** may have any number of buttons or other mechanical input mechanisms. In addition, the controller **106** may have an IMU so that the pose of the controller **106** may be tracked. The controller **106** may further be tracked based on predetermined patterns on the controller. For example, the controller **106** may have several infrared LEDs or other known observable features that collectively form a predetermined pattern. Using a sensor or camera, the virtual reality system **50** may be able to capture an image of the predetermined pattern on the controller. Based on the observed orientation of those patterns, the system may compute the controller's position and orientation relative to the sensor or camera.

(23) The virtual reality system **50** may further include a computing system **110**. The computing system **110** may be a stand-alone unit that is physically separate from the VR display device **135** or the computer system **110** may be integrated with the VR display device **135**. In embodiments where the computing system **110** is a separate unit, the computing system **110** may be communicatively coupled to the VR display device **135** via a wireless or wired link. The computing system **110** may be a high-performance device, such as a desktop or laptop, or a resource-limited device, such as a mobile phone. A high-performance device may have a dedicated GPU and a high-capacity or constant power source. A resource-limited device, on the other hand, may not have a GPU and may have limited battery capacity. As such, the algorithms that could be practically used by a virtual reality system **50** depends on the capabilities of its computing system **110**.

(24) In embodiments where the computing system **110** is a high-performance device, an embodiment of the passthrough feature may be designed as follows. Through the external-facing cameras **105A-B** of the VR display device **135**, a sequence of images of the surrounding physical environment may be captured. The information captured by the cameras **105A-B**, however, may be misaligned with what the user's eyes may capture since the cameras could not spatially coincide with the user's eyes (e.g., the cameras may be located some distance away from the user's eyes and, consequently, have different viewpoints). As such, simply displaying what the cameras captured to the user may not be an accurate representation of what the user should perceive.

(25) Instead of simply displaying what was captured, the passthrough feature may re-project information captured by the external-facing cameras **105A-B** to the user. Each pair of simultaneously captured stereo images may be used to estimate the depths of observed features. As explained above, to measure depth using triangulation, the computing system **110** may find correspondences between the stereo images. For example, the computing system **110** may determine which two pixels in the pair of stereo images correspond to the same observed feature. A high-performance computing system **110** may solve the correspondence problem using its GPU and optical flow techniques, which are optimized for such tasks. The correspondence information may then be used to compute depths using triangulation techniques. Based on the computed depths of the observed features, the computing system **110** could determine where those features are located within a 3D space (since the computing system **110** also knows where the cameras are in that 3D space). The result may be represented by a dense 3D point cloud, with each point corresponding to

an observed feature. The dense point cloud may then be used to generate 3D models of objects in the environment. When the system renders a scene for display, the system could perform visibility tests from the perspectives of the user's eyes. For example, the system may cast rays into the 3D space from a viewpoint that corresponds to each eye of the user. In this manner, the rendered scene that is displayed to the user may be computed from the perspective of the user's eyes, rather than from the perspective of the external-facing cameras **105A-B**.

(26) The process described above, however, may not be feasible for a resource-limited computing unit (e.g., a mobile phone may be the main computational unit for the VR display device). For example, unlike systems with powerful computational resources and ample energy sources, a mobile phone cannot rely on GPUs and computationally-expensive algorithms (e.g., optical flow) to perform depth measurements and generate an accurate 3D model of the environment. Thus, to provide passthrough on resource-limited devices, an optimized process is needed.

(27) In particular embodiments, the computing device may be configured to dynamically determine, at runtime, whether it is capable of or able to generate depth measurements using (1) the GPU and optical flow or (2) the optimized technique using video encoder and motion vectors, as described in further detail below. For example, if the device has a GPU and sufficient power budget (e.g., it is plugged into a power source, has a full battery, etc.), it may perform depth measurements using its GPU and optical flow. However, if the device does not have a GPU or has a stringent power budget, then it may opt for the optimized method for computing depths.

(28) FIG. 1C illustrates a virtual reality system **50** within a real-world environment **100**. Within the real-world environment **100** may be a camera **105** (e.g., one or more cameras, front facing cameras on an AR/VR headset, etc.). The camera **105** may be connected to a computing system **110**. The camera **105** may be worn by a user (e.g., as part of a VR headset). The camera **105** may be connected to a VR display device **135** (in particular embodiments, the camera **105** and the VR display device **135** may be separate). In particular embodiments, the computing system **110** may render, for one or more displays of the VR display device **135**, a first output image of the VR environment **140** based on a field of view **120** of a user. The VR environment **140** may have a virtual boundary **115** corresponding to the real-world environment **100**. The VR environment **140** may be a VR game, VR office, or other VR setting that is displayed in the field of view **120** of the user. The virtual boundary **115** may define or mark the edge of a safe area for the user to explore while the user is immersed in the VR environment **140**. For example, in a room-scale VR environment (where the user can walk around a room during the VR experience) the virtual boundary **115** may correspond to real-world objects **145** (e.g., sofas, chairs, tables, walls, impediments, etc.) that the user wearing the VR display device **135** may like to avoid while immersed in the VR experience. As another example, in a stationary VR setting (e.g., when the user is standing or sitting in a spot without traversing), the virtual boundary **115** may correspond to real-world objects at or just beyond arm's reach of the user (e.g., a 1 meter radius around the user). The virtual boundary **115** may be drawn by the user (e.g., by having the user manually draw the virtual boundary **115** using the controller **106**), automatically determined (e.g., an image processor may determine a safe boundary and automatically determines the boundary wall), or semi-automatically determined (e.g., an image processor may determine or suggest a safe boundary and the boundary wall **115**, and the user may manually augment or edit the determined boundary wall **115**). Although this disclosure describes using a particular virtual reality system in a particular real-world environment, this disclosure contemplates using any suitable virtual reality system in any suitable real-world environment.

(29) In particular embodiments, the computing system **110** may determine whether the user is approaching within a first threshold distance of the virtual boundary **115**. The computing system **110** may determine whether the user is approaching within a first threshold distance of the virtual boundary **115** using sensors, accelerometers, gyroscopes, or other position sensors of the camera **105** and/or the VR display device **135**. The first threshold distance may be a predetermined

distance (e.g., 1, 5, 10, etc. meters) from the virtual boundary **115**. The first threshold distance may be determined by the user as well. As an example and not by way of limitation, in a room-scale VR setting, the computing system **110** may determine whether the user is approaching within a pre-determined distance of the virtual boundary **115**. As another example and not by way of limitation, in a stationary VR setting, the first threshold distance may be when the user's head or hands approach the edge of the predetermined radius around the user (e.g., when the user's head or hands approaches a pre-determined 1 meter radius). Although this disclosure describes determining whether the user is approaching within a particular threshold distance of the virtual boundary in a particular manner, this disclosure contemplates determining whether the user is approaching within any suitable threshold distance of the virtual boundary in any suitable manner.

(30) FIG. 1D illustrates a perspective view of a passthrough view **130** of the real-world environment **100** within the VR environment **140**. The VR environment **140** may be rendered within the real-world environment **100**. As a user approaches a virtual boundary, a portion of the passthrough view **130** can appear to show the user a real-world object that the user may risk running into (e.g., the real-world object **145**). Thus, as the user gets close to the virtual boundary, a portion of the rendering of the VR environment **140** may transition to appear as a rendering showing the portion of the passthrough view **130**. The portion of the passthrough view **130** can show the user the real-world environment **100**, which may have the real-world object in the user's path, to prevent the user from risk of injury by showing the user the real-world object that may lie beyond the virtual boundary if the user continues along their path. The rendering as shown in FIG. 1D may be presented to the user through the VR display device **135** shown in FIG. 1B. That is, the portion of the passthrough view **130** may be used to capture information about the real-world object **145** in the real-world environment **100** and re-projected to the user.

(31) FIGS. 2A-2D illustrate top-down views of passthrough views **130** of the real-world environment **100** within the VR environment **140**. In particular embodiments, the computing system **110** may determine, responsive to the user approaching within the first threshold distance of the virtual boundary **115**, a direction of movement **125** and the field of view **120** of the user. The computing system **110** may determine the direction of movement **125** and the field of view **120** of the user using sensors, accelerometers, gyroscopes, or other position sensors of the camera **105** and/or the VR display device **135** to determine the motion and orientation of the user wearing the camera **105** and/or the VR display device **135**. As an example and not by way of limitation, sensors may determine the user is moving forward (e.g., in the direction of movement **125a**) along the same direction as their field of view **120** (FIG. 2A). As another example and not by way of limitation, sensors may determine the user is moving backward (e.g., in the direction of movement **125b**) in the opposite direction as their field of view **120** (FIG. 2B). As another example and not by way of limitation, sensors may determine the user is moving sideways to the left (e.g., in the direction of movement **125c**) and perpendicular to their field of view **120** (FIG. 2C). As another example and not by way of limitation, sensors may determine the user is moving sideways to the right (e.g., in the direction of movement **125d**) and perpendicular to their field of view **120** (FIG. 2D). Although this disclosure describes determining the direction of movement and the field of view of the user, this disclosure contemplates determining a direction of movement and the field of view of the user in any suitable manner.

(32) In particular embodiments, the computing system **110** may access one or more images of the real-world environment **100** captured by one or more cameras **105** of the VR display device **135**. The computing system **110** may access one or more images of the real-world environment **100** by capturing an image (e.g., by taking a picture or snapshot) of the user's real-world environment **100** using the camera **105**. This captured image may be a partial picture of the real-world environment **100** (e.g., the camera only captures the image of a desired orientation such as the user's field of view or the peripheral views) or a full picture of the real-world environment **100** (e.g., the camera captures a full 360 degree image of the user's entire real-world surroundings). Although this

disclosure describes accessing one or more images of the real-world environment in a particular manner, this disclosure contemplates accessing one or more images of the real-world environment in any suitable manner.

(33) In particular embodiments, the computing system **110** may render, for the one or more displays of the VR display device **135**, a second output image comprising a portion of the VR environment **140** and a portion of a passthrough view **130** of the real-world environment **100** based on the accessed images. The portion of the passthrough view **130** may be based on the determined direction of movement **125** and the field of view **120** of the user. The passthrough view **130** may provide the user a view of the real-world environment **100** beyond the VR environment **140** as the user approaches the virtual boundary **115**, without drastically breaking the immersion of the VR environment. That is, as the user approaches the virtual boundary **115**, the directional passthrough view **130** may be displayed on the VR display device **135** to give the user a sense of the direction the user is moving in the real-world environment **100**, while maintaining the VR environment **140** everywhere else. Thus, the computing system may provide a solution to the technical challenge of conveying spatial information about the real-world environment **100** and real-world objects **145** within the real-world environment **100** to a user while the user is immersed in a VR experience in the VR environment **140**. The solution presented herein may address this challenge by providing a quick glimpse via the portion of the directional passthrough view **130** to the real-world environment **100** so the user may ascertain where they are in the real-world environment **100**. This may have the advantage of helping the user avoid objects they may run into if they continue along their trajectory or path, and also help the user orient themselves in the real-world environment **100**. For example, the user may reposition themselves in the center of the virtual boundary **115** after viewing the directional passthrough view **130**. As an example and not by way of limitation, and with reference to FIG. 2A, if the user is moving forward (e.g., in the direction of movement **125a**) along the same direction as their field of view **120**, the VR display device **135** may display the VR environment **140** and the portion of the passthrough view **130a** that is directly in front of the user, while maintaining the VR environment **140** everywhere else. As another example and not by way of limitation, and with reference to FIG. 2B, if the user is moving backward (e.g., in the direction of movement **125b**) in the opposite direction as their field of view **120**, the VR display device **135** may display the VR environment **140** and the portion of the passthrough view **130b** that covers the user's peripheral view and behind the user, while maintaining the VR environment **140** everywhere else. As another example and not by way of limitation, and with reference to FIG. 2C, if the user is moving sideways to the left (e.g., in the direction of movement **125c**) and perpendicular to their field of view **120**, the VR display device **135** may display the VR environment **140** and the portion of the passthrough view **130c** that covers the user's peripheral view to the left, while maintaining the VR environment **140** everywhere else. As another example and not by way of limitation, and with reference to FIG. 2D, if the user is moving sideways to the right (e.g., in the direction of movement **125d**) and perpendicular to their field of view **120**, the VR display device **135** may display the VR environment **140** and the portion of the passthrough view **130d** that covers the user's peripheral view to the right, while maintaining the VR environment **140** everywhere else. Thus, the computing system **110** can render the passthrough view **130** to alert the user to objects in their path, and to help the user orient themselves in the room. Thus, the embodiments may include the technical advantage of providing spatial information by providing quick glimpse of the real-world environment through directional passthrough views of the real-world environment while immersed in the VR environment. Although this disclosure describes rendering a particular output image in a particular manner, this disclosure contemplates rendering any suitable output image in any suitable manner.

(34) FIGS. 3A-3D illustrates sample perspective views of the portion of the passthrough view **130** of the real-world environment **100** within the VR environment **140**, without adjustments for the field of view **120**. FIGS. 4A-4D illustrates sample perspective views of the portion of the

passthrough view **130** of the real-world environment **100** within the VR environment **140**, with adjustments for the field of view **120**. The portion of the passthrough view **130** may be adjusted to be able to consistently notify the user when the user strays from the center of the virtual boundary, or when the user approaches the virtual boundary from any direction. This may be accomplished by increasing the size of the arc or area of the portion of the passthrough view **130** to ensure at least part of the portion of the passthrough view **130** is always within the field of view **120**. This can provide the technical advantage of providing spatial information by determining the optimal direction for the directional passthrough view, regardless of which direction the user is moving. As an example and not by way of limitation, with reference to FIG. 3A, if the user is moving forward with the movement of direction **125** that is along the same direction as their field of view **120**, the portion of the passthrough view **130** lies fully within the field of view **120**, and thus may not need any adjustment. Therefore, with reference to FIG. 4A, there may be no adjustment of the portion of the passthrough view **130**. As another example and not by way of limitation, with reference to FIG. 3B, if the user is moving with the movement of direction **125** that is angled away from their field of view **120**, the portion of the passthrough view **130** and the field of view **120** do not completely overlap, and thus the portion of the passthrough view **130** may need adjustment. Therefore, with reference to FIG. 4B, there may be an adjustment to increase the portion of the portion of the passthrough view **130**. For example, if the overlap of the field of view **120** and the portion of the passthrough view was 5 degrees (as in FIG. 3B), then the size of the portion of the passthrough view **130** may be increased by 30 degrees so that the overlap of the field of view **120** and the portion of the passthrough view **130** may be increased to 20 degrees (as in FIG. 4B). As another example and not by way of limitation, with reference to FIG. 3C, if the user is moving with the movement of direction **125** that is perpendicular to their field of view **120**, the portion of the passthrough view **130** and the field of view **120** may not overlap at all, and thus the portion of the passthrough view **130** may need adjustment. Therefore, with reference to FIG. 4C, there may be an adjustment to increase the portion of the portion of the passthrough view **130**. For example, if the overlap of the field of view **120** and the portion of the passthrough view was 0 degrees (as in FIG. 3C), then the size of the portion of the passthrough view **130** may be increased by 32 degrees so that the overlap of the field of view **120** and the portion of the passthrough view **130** may be increased to 15 degrees (as in FIG. 4C). As another example and not by way of limitation, with reference to FIG. 3D, if the user is moving with the movement of direction **125** that is opposite to their field of view **120**, the portion of the passthrough view **130** and the field of view **120** may not overlap at all, and thus the portion of the passthrough view **130** may need adjustment. Therefore, with reference to FIG. 4D, there may be an adjustment to increase the portion of the portion of the passthrough view **130**. For example, if the overlap of the field of view **120** and the portion of the passthrough view was 0 degrees (as in FIG. 3D), then the size of the portion of the passthrough view **130** may be increased by 190 degrees so that the overlap of the field of view **120** and the portion of the passthrough view **130** may be increased to 15 degrees (as in FIG. 4D). With the above field of view adjustments to the portion of the passthrough view **130**, the computing system **110** may render the passthrough view **130** which can alert the user to objects in their path, and to help the user orient themselves in the room.

(35) FIG. 5A illustrates a sample perspective view of a compensation **160** for the adjustment of the field of view **120**. The direction of the field of view **120** may be represented by a forward vector **165**. The direction of the user from the center of the virtual boundary **115** (not shown) may be represented by a direction vector **155**. Based on the forward vector **165** and the direction vector **155**, a compensation **160** may be determined to adjust the portion of the passthrough view **130**. For example, as the angle between the forward vector **165** and the direction vector **155** increases (e.g., as the angle of the arc **170** decreases), the compensation **160** may increase as well. The compensation **160** is the angle that the direction vector **155** may need to rotate to reach the field of view **120**, e.g., to ensure at least some of the portion of the passthrough view **130** lies within the

field of view **120**. The increase of the compensation **160** may be proportional to the decrease of the arc **170**.

(36) FIGS. 5B-5C are graphs illustrating the percent compensation of transitions into passthrough views. The x-axis represents the distance between the portion of the passthrough view and the field of view, with $x=0$ representing the portion of the passthrough view and the field of view are just not overlapping, and $x=1$ representing the portion of the passthrough view and the field of view are in opposite directions (e.g., the portion of the passthrough view points away from the field of view). The y-axis represents the percent compensation for the portion of the passthrough view. As shown by a percent compensation line **161** in FIG. 5B, once the user's direction of movement is out of the user's field of view (e.g., once the percent compensation line **161** crosses the y-axis), the compensation for the passthrough begins. As the sudden transition into the portion of the passthrough view may be very noticeable, the sudden transition may disrupt or distract from the VR experience. As shown by a percent compensation line **162** in FIG. 5C, the transition into passthrough view may be more gradual. The compensation for the passthrough view can gradually begin even before the user's direction of movement is out of the user's field of view (e.g., before the percent compensation line **162** crosses the y-axis), thus smoothing the transition into passthrough view. An advantage of having a smoothed transition into passthrough view includes having a less disruptive and more gradual introduction of the passthrough view, which may make it less noticeable to determine when the compensation starts and ends. Additionally, as the curve approaches $x=1$ (e.g., when the portion of the passthrough view and the field of view are in opposite directions), the compensation may increase the passthrough view to all sides of the user's vision, as seeing the passthrough view on all sides of the user's periphery may make it easier to notice objects and obstructions than just showing the passthrough view on one side.

(37) In particular embodiments, referring again to FIGS. 2A-2D, 3A-3D, and 4A-4D, the computing system **110** may determine a speed of the movement of the user. An area (e.g., the size) of the portion of the passthrough view **130** may be based on the determined speed of the user. The portion of the passthrough view **130** may be a spherical cap of a spherical second output image (e.g., the portion of the passthrough view is a portion of a spherical surface, where the spherical surface corresponds to the VR environment that is rendered on a "spherical dome" around the user). If the user is moving at faster speeds, then the area of the portion of the passthrough view **130** may be relatively larger for a faster determined speed of the movement of the user than it may be for a user moving at a slower determined speed. As such, the portion of the passthrough view may take up a larger area of the output image displayed by the VR display device **135**. If the user is moving at slower speeds, then the area of the portion of the passthrough view **130** may be relatively smaller for a slower determined speed of the movement of the user than it may be for a user moving at a faster determined speed. As such, the portion of the passthrough view may take up a smaller area of the output image displayed by the VR display device **135**. If the output image is rendered as a spherical dome around the user, then the portion of the VR passthrough view may be a spherical cap in the spherical dome. However, the portion of the passthrough view **130** may be any shape (e.g., the shape is not limited to a circular view for the portion of the passthrough view **130**). As an example and not by way of limitation, if the user is walking at a fast pace toward the virtual boundary **115**, the portion of the passthrough view **130** may appear be relatively larger than in it may be if the user walked toward the virtual boundary **115** at a slower pace. Conversely, if the user is walking slowly toward the virtual boundary **115**, the portion of the passthrough view **130** may appear to be relatively smaller than it may be if the user walked toward the virtual boundary **115** at a faster pace. Although this disclosure describes determining a speed of the movement of the user in a particular manner, this disclosure contemplates determining a speed of the movement of the user in any suitable manner.

(38) In particular embodiments, a sharpness of a transition from the VR environment **140** to the portion of the passthrough view **130** may be based on the determined speed of the movement of the

user. The transition may be a fade, blur, or other form of visual interruption or transition from the VR environment **140** into the portion of the passthrough view **130**. That is, when the transition from the VR environment **140** to the portion of the passthrough view **130** may involve fading or blurring the edges where the VR environment **140** and the portion of the passthrough view **130** meet. The sharpness of the transition from the VR environment **140** to the portion of the passthrough view **130** may be relatively sharper for a faster determined speed of the movement of the user, and the sharpness of the transition from the VR environment **140** to the portion of the passthrough view **130** may be relatively less sharp for a slower determined speed of the movement of the user. As an example and not by way of limitation, if the user is walking quickly toward the virtual boundary **115**, there will be less fade or blur from the VR environment **140** to the portion of the passthrough view **130** (the transition from the VR environment **140** to the portion of the passthrough view **130** will be relatively sharper). This may allow the user to quickly assess obstacles that may be in the user's path, as faster user movement could increase the likelihood or risk of tripping over or running into an object. Conversely, if the user is walking slowly toward the virtual boundary **115**, there will be more fade or blur from the virtual environment **140** to the portion of the passthrough view **130** (the transition from the VR environment **140** to the portion of the passthrough view **130** will be relatively less sharp). This may allow the user to assess their position in the real-world environment using the passthrough view, without greatly detracting from the user's VR experience (thus minimizing the disruption from the VR immersion and experience). Although this disclosure describes determining the speed of the movement of the user to determine the sharpness of the transition in a particular manner, this disclosure contemplates determining the speed of the movement of the user to determine the sharpness of the transition in any suitable manner.

(39) FIG. 6 illustrates a sample diagrammatic view of a user's vision **200**. The user may have central vision **205**, paracentral vision **210**, macular vision **215**, near peripheral vision **220**, mid peripheral vision **225**, and far peripheral vision **230**. As human peripheral vision may only be able to detect high contrast movement, it may be advantageous to have increased sharpness at the user's peripheral visions, while maintaining decreased sharpness (e.g., increased blurring or “feathering”) near the center of the field of view to minimize the disruption of the VR experience. That is, for a headset field of view **235**, a sharpness **245** of a gradient **240** of the passthrough view may be increased at the user's peripheral visions (e.g., near peripheral vision **220**, mid peripheral vision **225**, and far peripheral vision **230**) to allow more visibility of the real-world environment where only high contrast movement may be detected. On the other hand, the sharpness **245** of the gradient **240** of the passthrough view may be decreased (e.g., by increasing the blur or “feathering” of the gradient **240**) for the headset field of view **235** that corresponds to central vision **205**, the paracentral vision **210**, and the macular vision **215**. Thus, the user may be able to detect visual objects and obstructions in the real-world environment more easily at their peripheral vision (e.g., their near peripheral vision **220**, mid peripheral vision **225**, and far peripheral vision **230**), with the benefit of decreasing the distraction of the passthrough view near their central vision **205**, paracentral vision **210**, and macular vision **215**. This may provide the user with more visual clarity of their surroundings without greatly interrupting or disrupting the VR experience.

(40) In particular embodiments, referring to FIGS. 2A-2D, 3A-3D, and 4A-4D, the rendered portion of the passthrough view **130** may correspond to the direction of the movement **125** of the user. The location of the portion of the passthrough view **130** as displayed in the VR display device **135** may correspond to the direction of movement **125** of the user. If the user walks forward and straight, the portion of the passthrough view **130** may appear straight ahead of the user, centered in the user's field of view **120** and along the direction of movement **125**. If the direction of movement **125** of the user is slightly forward and to the left, the portion of the passthrough view **130** as displayed in the VR display device **135** may appear along that direction of movement **125**—ahead of and slightly to the left of the center of the user's field of view **120**. As an example and not by

way of limitation, the rendered portion of the passthrough view **130** may be in the field of view **120** of the user when the direction of movement **125** of the user is determined to be toward the field of view **120**. As another example and not by way of limitation, the rendered portion of the passthrough view **130** may be in a peripheral view of the user when the direction of movement **125** is determined to be perpendicular to the field of view **120**. That is, the field of view may be to the left or the right of the user's field of view **120**, in the user's periphery. This may allow the user to use their peripheral view to be alerted to potential obstacles or objects that may lie in their path. As another example and not by way of limitation, the rendered portion of the passthrough view **130** may be in peripheral view of and behind the user when the direction of movement **125** is determined to be away from the field of view **120**. That is, when the user is walking backwards in a direction opposite of their field of view **120**, the portion of the passthrough view **130** may cover both the left and right sides of the user's peripheral view, as well as the portion behind the user (beyond the user's field of view **120** and the user's peripheral view).

(41) FIG. 7 illustrates a perspective view of the user in a boundary space **175**. The boundary space **175** may have a center **180** (which may, for example, correspond to the center of a real-world room in the real-world environment). The boundary space **175** may include a boundary **190** having one or more threshold boundaries that the user may want to customize. For example, the user may customize the boundary space **175** to include a starting threshold boundary **185**, and an end boundary **195**. Depending on the direction vector **155** of the user (e.g., as the user moves further away from or closer to the center of the boundary space **175**), the computing system **110** (not shown) of the camera **105** may display on the VR display device **135** (not shown) the portion of the passthrough view with an increasing or decreasing size and sharpness. As an example, if the user is at the starting boundary **185**, the size of the portion of the passthrough view may be relatively smaller than it may be if the user was at the boundary **190**. The sharpness of the portion of the passthrough view may be relatively less sharp at the starting boundary **185** than it may be at the boundary **190**. As another example, if the user is at the end boundary **195**, the size of the portion of the passthrough view may be relatively larger than it may be if the user was at the boundary **190**. The sharpness of the portion of the passthrough view may be relatively sharper at the end boundary **195** than it may be at the boundary **190**.

(42) FIG. 8 illustrates a perspective view of an outline rendering view of a real-world object **150** in the VR environment **140**. Referring to FIGS. 1C and 8, in particular embodiments, the computing system **110** may render, for the one or more displays of the VR display device **135**, a third output image comprising one or more real-world objects **145** beyond the virtual boundary as the outline rendering view of the real-world object **150**, e.g., as one or more mixed reality (MR) objects. The outline rendering view of the real-world object **150** may correspond to the real-world object **145** that may lie beyond the virtual boundary **115**. The outline rendered object may be rendered as an outline of the one or more real-world objects **145**, a semi-opaque rendering of the one or more real-world objects **145**, a fully opaque rendering of the one or more real-world objects **145**, or other similar rendering. The outline rendered object may be used to alert the user to the presence of the one or more real-world objects **145** by showing the user the outline rendering view of the real-world object **150**, which may correspond to the pose of the real-world object **145** in the real-world environment. That is, a technical advantage of the embodiments may include providing spatial information by providing outline renderings of real-world objects in the VR environment to alert the user of objects that may lie in their path without significantly disrupting the immersion of the VR experience. Thus, the user may be provided a safe and subtle alert or warning to the presence of an obstacle without frustrating the user VR experience or breaking the immersion. As an example and not by way of limitation, if the one or more real-world objects **145** (e.g., a desk) lies beyond the virtual boundary **115** (as illustrated in FIG. 1C), then the one or more real-world objects **145** may appear as an outline rendered object (e.g., the MR object of the outline rendering view of the real-world object **150**) in the user's VR display device **135**. While in the VR environment **140**,

the user may be able to see a “ghostly” semi-opaque outline of the object **145** (e.g., a desk) without having to leave the VR environment **140**. The outline rendering view of the real-world object **150** may alert the user to avoid the desk and continue on in the VR experience. The outline rendered object (e.g., the rendered outline of the desk) can fade into view and then fade away as the user walks away from the desk, for example, if the computing system determines the real-world object (e.g., the desk) does not pose a risk to the user. Thus, the computing system **110** may provide a solution to the technical challenge of maintaining the immersion of the VR experience while also providing the user with the necessary visual information to orient themselves in the virtual boundary. The solution presented herein may address this challenge by rendering an opaque, translucent, or otherwise outline rendered view of the real-world object **150** in the VR environment **140** to alert the user to the presence of the real-world object **145**, without significantly interrupting the VR experience. Although this disclosure describes rendering a third output image in a particular manner, this disclosure contemplates rendering any suitable output image in any suitable manner.

(43) In particular embodiments, the computing system **110** may determine whether the user is approaching within a second threshold distance of the virtual boundary **115**. The second threshold distance may be greater than the first threshold distance. For example, if the first threshold distance is 1 meter from the virtual boundary **115**, the second threshold distance may be 2 meters from the virtual boundary **115**. Although this disclosure describes determining whether the user is approaching within a second threshold distance in a particular manner, this disclosure contemplates determining whether the user is approaching within any threshold distance in any suitable manner.

(44) In particular embodiments, referring to FIGS. 1C, 2A-2D, and 8, the computing system **110** may determine, responsive to the user approaching within the second threshold distance of the virtual boundary **115**, the direction of movement **125** and the field of view **120** of the user. As described above, the computing system **110** may determine the direction of movement **125** and the field of view **120** of the user using sensors, accelerometers, gyroscopes, or other position sensors of the camera **105** and/or the VR display device **135** to determine the motion and orientation of the user wearing the camera **105** and/or the VR display device **135**. As an example and not by way of limitation, sensors may determine the user is moving forward (e.g., in the direction of movement **125a**) along the same direction as their field of view **120** and approaching within the second threshold distance of the virtual boundary **115** (FIG. 2A). As another example and not by way of limitation, sensors may determine the user is moving backward (e.g., in the direction of movement **125b**) in the opposite direction as their field of view **120** and approaching within the second threshold distance of the virtual boundary **115** (FIG. 2B). As another example and not by way of limitation, sensors may determine the user is moving sideways to the left (e.g., in the direction of movement **125c**) and perpendicular to their field of view **120** and approaching within the second threshold distance of the virtual boundary **115** (FIG. 2C). As another example and not by way of limitation, sensors may determine the user is moving sideways to the right (e.g., in the direction of movement **125d**) and perpendicular to their field of view **120** and approaching within the second threshold distance of the virtual boundary **115** (FIG. 2D). Although this disclosure describes determining the direction of movement **125** and the field of view **120** of the user in a particular manner, this disclosure contemplates determining the direction of movement and the field of view of the user in any suitable manner.

(45) In particular embodiments, the computing system **110** may access one or more additional images of the real-world environment **100** containing the one or more real-world objects **145** captured by cameras **105** of the VR display device **135**. The third output image may have the one or more real-world objects **145** in the accessed additional images. The computing system **110** may access one or more images of the real-world environment **100** by taking a picture or snapshot (e.g., capturing an image) of the user's real-world environment **100** using the camera **105**. An object detection filter or an edge detection filter (e.g., a Sobel filter) may detect the one or more real-world objects **145** in the vicinity of the user's real-world environment **100**. As an example and not

by way of limitation, the camera **105** may be used to detect the edges of the one or more real-world objects **145**, such as a desk, that is in the user's real-world environment **100**. The third output image may then include the desk that was captured by the camera **105**. Although this disclosure describes accessing one or more additional images in a particular manner, this disclosure contemplates accessing images in any suitable manner.

(46) FIG. **9** illustrates an example method **900** for determining spatial awareness in a VR setting using a passthrough view. The method may begin at step **910**, where a computing system may include rendering for one or more displays of a VR display device **135**, a first output image of a VR environment based on a field of view of a user, wherein the VR environment comprises a virtual boundary corresponding to a real-world environment. At step **920**, the method may include determining whether the user is approaching within a first threshold distance of the virtual boundary. At step **930**, the method may include determining responsive to the user approaching within the first threshold distance of the virtual boundary, a direction of movement and the field of view of the user. At step **940**, the method may include accessing one or more images of the real-world environment captured by one or more cameras of the VR display device. At step **950**, the method may include rendering, for the one or more displays of the VR display device, a second output image comprising a portion of the VR environment and a portion of a passthrough view of the real-world environment based on the accessed images, wherein the portion of the passthrough view is based on the determined direction of movement and the field of view of the user. Particular embodiments may repeat one or more steps of the method of FIG. **9**, where appropriate. Although this disclosure describes and illustrates particular steps of the method of FIG. **9** as occurring in a particular order, this disclosure contemplates any suitable steps of the method of FIG. **9** occurring in any suitable order. Moreover, although this disclosure describes and illustrates an example method for determining spatial awareness in a VR setting using a passthrough view including the particular steps of the method of FIG. **9**, this disclosure contemplates any suitable method for determining spatial awareness in a VR setting using a passthrough view including any suitable steps, which may include all, some, or none of the steps of the method of FIG. **9**, where appropriate. Furthermore, although this disclosure describes and illustrates particular components, devices, or systems carrying out particular steps of the method of FIG. **9**, this disclosure contemplates any suitable combination of any suitable components, devices, or systems carrying out any suitable steps of the method of FIG. **9**.

(47) FIG. **10** illustrates an example network environment **1000** associated with a VR or social-networking system. Network environment **1000** includes a client system **1030**, a VR or social-networking system **1060**, and a third-party system **1070** connected to each other by a network **1010**. Although FIG. **10** illustrates a particular arrangement of client system **1030**, VR or social-networking system **1060**, third-party system **1070**, and network **1010**, this disclosure contemplates any suitable arrangement of client system **1030**, VR or social-networking system **1060**, third-party system **1070**, and network **1010**. As an example and not by way of limitation, two or more of client system **1030**, VR or social-networking system **1060**, and third-party system **1070** may be connected to each other directly, bypassing network **1010**. As another example, two or more of client system **1030**, VR or social-networking system **1060**, and third-party system **1070** may be physically or logically co-located with each other in whole or in part. Moreover, although FIG. **10** illustrates a particular number of client systems **1030**, VR or social-networking systems **1060**, third-party systems **1070**, and networks **1010**, this disclosure contemplates any suitable number of client systems **1030**, VR or social-networking systems **1060**, third-party systems **1070**, and networks **1010**. As an example and not by way of limitation, network environment **1000** may include multiple client system **1030**, VR or social-networking systems **1060**, third-party systems **1070**, and networks **1010**.

(48) This disclosure contemplates any suitable network **1010**. As an example and not by way of limitation, one or more portions of network **1010** may include an ad hoc network, an intranet, an

extranet, a virtual private network (VPN), a local area network (LAN), a wireless LAN (WLAN), a wide area network (WAN), a wireless WAN (WWAN), a metropolitan area network (MAN), a portion of the Internet, a portion of the Public Switched Telephone Network (PSTN), a cellular telephone network, or a combination of two or more of these. Network **1010** may include one or more networks **1010**.

(49) Links **1050** may connect client system **1030**, social-networking system **1060**, and third-party system **1070** to communication network **1010** or to each other. This disclosure contemplates any suitable links **1050**. In particular embodiments, one or more links **1050** include one or more wireline (such as for example Digital Subscriber Line (DSL) or Data Over Cable Service Interface Specification (DOCSIS)), wireless (such as for example Wi-Fi or Worldwide Interoperability for Microwave Access (WiMAX)), or optical (such as for example Synchronous Optical Network (SONET) or Synchronous Digital Hierarchy (SDH)) links. In particular embodiments, one or more links **1050** each include an ad hoc network, an intranet, an extranet, a VPN, a LAN, a WLAN, a WAN, a WWAN, a MAN, a portion of the Internet, a portion of the PSTN, a cellular technology-based network, a satellite communications technology-based network, another link **1050**, or a combination of two or more such links **1050**. Links **1050** need not necessarily be the same throughout network environment **1000**. One or more first links **1050** may differ in one or more respects from one or more second links **1050**.

(50) In particular embodiments, client system **1030** may be an electronic device including hardware, software, or embedded logic components or a combination of two or more such components and capable of carrying out the appropriate functionalities implemented or supported by client system **1030**. As an example and not by way of limitation, a client system **1030** may include a computer system such as a desktop computer, notebook or laptop computer, netbook, a tablet computer, e-book reader, GPS device, camera, personal digital assistant (PDA), handheld electronic device, cellular telephone, smartphone, augmented/virtual reality device, other suitable electronic device, or any suitable combination thereof. This disclosure contemplates any suitable client systems **1030**. A client system **1030** may enable a network user at client system **1030** to access network **1010**. A client system **1030** may enable its user to communicate with other users at other client systems **1030**.

(51) In particular embodiments, client system **1030** (e.g., an HMD) may include a passthrough engine **1032** to provide the passthrough feature described herein, and may have one or more add-ons, plug-ins, or other extensions. A user at client system **1030** may connect to a particular server (such as server **1062**, or a server associated with a third-party system **1070**). The server may accept the request and communicate with the client system **1030**.

(52) In particular embodiments, VR or social-networking system **1060** may be a network-addressable computing system that can host an online Virtual Reality environment or social network. VR or social-networking system **1060** may generate, store, receive, and send social-networking data, such as, for example, user-profile data, concept-profile data, social-graph information, or other suitable data related to the online social network. Social-networking or VR system **1060** may be accessed by the other components of network environment **1000** either directly or via network **1010**. As an example and not by way of limitation, client system **1030** may access social-networking or VR system **1060** using a web browser, or a native application associated with social-networking or VR system **1060** (e.g., a mobile social-networking application, a messaging application, another suitable application, or any combination thereof) either directly or via network **1010**. In particular embodiments, social-networking or VR system **1060** may include one or more servers **1062**. Each server **1062** may be a unitary server or a distributed server spanning multiple computers or multiple datacenters. Servers **1062** may be of various types, such as, for example and without limitation, web server, news server, mail server, message server, advertising server, file server, application server, exchange server, database server, proxy server, another server suitable for performing functions or processes described herein, or any

combination thereof. In particular embodiments, each server **1062** may include hardware, software, or embedded logic components or a combination of two or more such components for carrying out the appropriate functionalities implemented or supported by server **1062**. In particular embodiments, social-networking or VR system **1060** may include one or more data stores **1064**. Data stores **1064** may be used to store various types of information. In particular embodiments, the information stored in data stores **1064** may be organized according to specific data structures. In particular embodiments, each data store **1064** may be a relational, columnar, correlation, or other suitable database. Although this disclosure describes or illustrates particular types of databases, this disclosure contemplates any suitable types of databases. Particular embodiments may provide interfaces that enable a client system **1030**, a social-networking or VR system **1060**, or a third-party system **1070** to manage, retrieve, modify, add, or delete, the information stored in data store **1064**.

(53) In particular embodiments, social-networking or VR system **1060** may store one or more social graphs in one or more data stores **1064**. In particular embodiments, a social graph may include multiple nodes—which may include multiple user nodes (each corresponding to a particular user) or multiple concept nodes (each corresponding to a particular concept)—and multiple edges connecting the nodes. Social-networking or VR system **1060** may provide users of the online social network the ability to communicate and interact with other users. In particular embodiments, users may join the online social network via social-networking or VR system **1060** and then add connections (e.g., relationships) to a number of other users of social-networking or VR system **1060** to whom they want to be connected. Herein, the term “friend” may refer to any other user of social-networking or VR system **1060** with whom a user has formed a connection, association, or relationship via social-networking or VR system **1060**.

(54) In particular embodiments, social-networking or VR system **1060** may provide users with the ability to take actions on various types of items or objects, supported by social-networking or VR system **1060**. As an example and not by way of limitation, the items and objects may include groups or social networks to which users of social-networking or VR system **1060** may belong, events or calendar entries in which a user might be interested, computer-based applications that a user may use, transactions that allow users to buy or sell items via the service, interactions with advertisements that a user may perform, or other suitable items or objects. A user may interact with anything that is capable of being represented in social-networking or VR system **1060** or by an external system of third-party system **1070**, which is separate from social-networking or VR system **1060** and coupled to social-networking or VR system **1060** via a network **1010**.

(55) In particular embodiments, social-networking or VR system **1060** may be capable of linking a variety of entities. As an example and not by way of limitation, social-networking or VR system **1060** may enable users to interact with each other as well as receive content from third-party systems **1070** or other entities, or to allow users to interact with these entities through an application programming interfaces (API) or other communication channels.

(56) In particular embodiments, a third-party system **1070** may include one or more types of servers, one or more data stores, one or more interfaces, including but not limited to APIs, one or more web services, one or more content sources, one or more networks, or any other suitable components, e.g., that servers may communicate with. A third-party system **1070** may be operated by a different entity from an entity operating social-networking or VR system **1060**. In particular embodiments, however, social-networking or VR system **1060** and third-party systems **1070** may operate in conjunction with each other to provide social-networking services to users of social-networking or VR system **1060** or third-party systems **1070**. In this sense, social-networking or VR system **1060** may provide a platform, or backbone, which other systems, such as third-party systems **1070**, may use to provide social-networking services and functionality to users across the Internet.

(57) In particular embodiments, a third-party system **1070** may include a third-party content object provider. A third-party content object provider may include one or more sources of content objects,

which may be communicated to a client system **1030**. As an example and not by way of limitation, content objects may include information regarding things or activities of interest to the user, such as, for example, movie show times, movie reviews, restaurant reviews, restaurant menus, product information and reviews, or other suitable information. As another example and not by way of limitation, content objects may include incentive content objects, such as coupons, discount tickets, gift certificates, or other suitable incentive objects.

(58) In particular embodiments, social-networking or VR system **1060** also includes user-generated content objects, which may enhance a user's interactions with social-networking or VR system **1060**. User-generated content may include anything a user can add, upload, send, or “post” to social-networking or VR system **1060**. As an example and not by way of limitation, a user communicates posts to social-networking or VR system **1060** from a client system **1030**. Posts may include data such as status updates or other textual data, location information, photos, videos, links, music or other similar data or media. Content may also be added to social-networking or VR system **1060** by a third-party through a “communication channel,” such as a newsfeed or stream.

(59) In particular embodiments, social-networking or VR system **1060** may include a variety of servers, sub-systems, programs, modules, logs, and data stores. In particular embodiments, social-networking or VR system **1060** may include one or more of the following: a web server, action logger, API-request server, relevance-and-ranking engine, content-object classifier, notification controller, action log, third-party-content-object-exposure log, inference module, authorization/privacy server, search module, advertisement-targeting module, user-interface module, user-profile store, connection store, third-party content store, or location store. Social-networking or VR system **1060** may also include suitable components such as network interfaces, security mechanisms, load balancers, failover servers, management-and-network-operations consoles, other suitable components, or any suitable combination thereof. In particular embodiments, social-networking or VR system **1060** may include one or more user-profile stores for storing user profiles. A user profile may include, for example, biographic information, demographic information, behavioral information, social information, or other types of descriptive information, such as work experience, educational history, hobbies or preferences, interests, affinities, or location. Interest information may include interests related to one or more categories. Categories may be general or specific. As an example and not by way of limitation, if a user “likes” an article about a brand of shoes the category may be the brand, or the general category of “shoes” or “clothing.” A connection store may be used for storing connection information about users. The connection information may indicate users who have similar or common work experience, group memberships, hobbies, educational history, or are in any way related or share common attributes. The connection information may also include user-defined connections between different users and content (both internal and external). A web server may be used for linking social-networking or VR system **1060** to one or more client systems **1030** or one or more third-party system **1070** via network **1010**. The web server may include a mail server or other messaging functionality for receiving and routing messages between social-networking or VR system **1060** and one or more client systems **1030**. An API-request server may allow a third-party system **1070** to access information from social-networking or VR system **1060** by calling one or more APIs. An action logger may be used to receive communications from a web server about a user's actions on or off social-networking or VR system **1060**. In conjunction with the action log, a third-party content-object log may be maintained of user exposures to third-party content objects. A notification controller may provide information regarding content objects to a client system **1030**. Information may be pushed to a client system **1030** as notifications, or information may be pulled from client system **1030** responsive to a request received from client system **1030**. Authorization servers may be used to enforce one or more privacy settings of the users of social-networking or VR system **1060**. A privacy setting of a user determines how particular information associated with a user may be shared. The authorization server may allow users to opt in to or opt out of having their actions

logged by social-networking or VR system **1060** or shared with other systems (e.g., third-party system **1070**), such as, for example, by setting appropriate privacy settings. Third-party content-object stores may be used to store content objects received from third parties, such as a third-party system **1070**. Location stores may be used for storing location information received from client systems **1030** associated with users. Advertisement-pricing modules may combine social information, the current time, location information, or other suitable information to provide relevant advertisements, in the form of notifications, to a user.

(60) FIG. **11** illustrates an example computer system **1100**. In particular embodiments, one or more computer systems **1100** perform one or more steps of one or more methods described or illustrated herein. In particular embodiments, one or more computer systems **1100** provide functionality described or illustrated herein. In particular embodiments, software running on one or more computer systems **1100** performs one or more steps of one or more methods described or illustrated herein or provides functionality described or illustrated herein. Particular embodiments include one or more portions of one or more computer systems **1100**. Herein, reference to a computer system may encompass a computing device, and vice versa, where appropriate. Moreover, reference to a computer system may encompass one or more computer systems, where appropriate.

(61) This disclosure contemplates any suitable number of computer systems **1100**. This disclosure contemplates computer system **1100** taking any suitable physical form. As example and not by way of limitation, computer system **1100** may be an embedded computer system, a system-on-chip (SOC), a single-board computer system (SBC) (such as, for example, a computer-on-module (COM) or system-on-module (SOM)), a desktop computer system, a laptop or notebook computer system, an interactive kiosk, a mainframe, a mesh of computer systems, a mobile telephone, a personal digital assistant (PDA), a server, a tablet computer system, an augmented/virtual reality device, or a combination of two or more of these. Where appropriate, computer system **1100** may include one or more computer systems **1100**; be unitary or distributed; span multiple locations; span multiple machines; span multiple data centers; or reside in a cloud, which may include one or more cloud components in one or more networks. Where appropriate, one or more computer systems **1100** may perform without substantial spatial or temporal limitation one or more steps of one or more methods described or illustrated herein. As an example and not by way of limitation, one or more computer systems **1100** may perform in real time or in batch mode one or more steps of one or more methods described or illustrated herein. One or more computer systems **1100** may perform at different times or at different locations one or more steps of one or more methods described or illustrated herein, where appropriate.

(62) In particular embodiments, computer system **1100** includes a processor **1102**, memory **1104**, storage **1106**, an input/output (I/O) interface **1108**, a communication interface **1110**, and a bus **1112**. Although this disclosure describes and illustrates a particular computer system having a particular number of particular components in a particular arrangement, this disclosure contemplates any suitable computer system having any suitable number of any suitable components in any suitable arrangement.

(63) In particular embodiments, processor **1102** includes hardware for executing instructions, such as those making up a computer program. As an example and not by way of limitation, to execute instructions, processor **1102** may retrieve (or fetch) the instructions from an internal register, an internal cache, memory **1104**, or storage **1106**; decode and execute them; and then write one or more results to an internal register, an internal cache, memory **1104**, or storage **1106**. In particular embodiments, processor **1102** may include one or more internal caches for data, instructions, or addresses. This disclosure contemplates processor **1102** including any suitable number of any suitable internal caches, where appropriate. As an example and not by way of limitation, processor **1102** may include one or more instruction caches, one or more data caches, and one or more translation lookaside buffers (TLBs). Instructions in the instruction caches may be copies of instructions in memory **1104** or storage **1106**, and the instruction caches may speed up retrieval of

those instructions by processor **1102**. Data in the data caches may be copies of data in memory **1104** or storage **1106** for instructions executing at processor **1102** to operate on; the results of previous instructions executed at processor **1102** for access by subsequent instructions executing at processor **1102** or for writing to memory **1104** or storage **1106**; or other suitable data. The data caches may speed up read or write operations by processor **1102**. The TLBs may speed up virtual-address translation for processor **1102**. In particular embodiments, processor **1102** may include one or more internal registers for data, instructions, or addresses. This disclosure contemplates processor **1102** including any suitable number of any suitable internal registers, where appropriate. Where appropriate, processor **1102** may include one or more arithmetic logic units (ALUs); be a multi-core processor; or include one or more processors **1102**. Although this disclosure describes and illustrates a particular processor, this disclosure contemplates any suitable processor.

(64) In particular embodiments, memory **1104** includes main memory for storing instructions for processor **1102** to execute or data for processor **1102** to operate on. As an example and not by way of limitation, computer system **1100** may load instructions from storage **1106** or another source (such as, for example, another computer system **1100**) to memory **1104**. Processor **602** may then load the instructions from memory **604** to an internal register or internal cache. To execute the instructions, processor **602** may retrieve the instructions from the internal register or internal cache and decode them. During or after execution of the instructions, processor **602** may write one or more results (which may be intermediate or final results) to the internal register or internal cache. Processor **602** may then write one or more of those results to memory **604**. In particular embodiments, processor **602** executes only instructions in one or more internal registers or internal caches or in memory **1104** (as opposed to storage **1106** or elsewhere) and operates only on data in one or more internal registers or internal caches or in memory **1104** (as opposed to storage **1106** or elsewhere). One or more memory buses (which may each include an address bus and a data bus) may couple processor **1102** to memory **1104**. Bus **1112** may include one or more memory buses, as described below. In particular embodiments, one or more memory management units (MMUs) reside between processor **1102** and memory **1104** and facilitate accesses to memory **1104** requested by processor **1102**. In particular embodiments, memory **1104** includes random access memory (RAM). This RAM may be volatile memory, where appropriate. Where appropriate, this RAM may be dynamic RAM (DRAM) or static RAM (SRAM). Moreover, where appropriate, this RAM may be single-ported or multi-ported RAM. This disclosure contemplates any suitable RAM. Memory **1104** may include one or more memories **1104**, where appropriate. Although this disclosure describes and illustrates particular memory, this disclosure contemplates any suitable memory.

(65) In particular embodiments, storage **1106** includes mass storage for data or instructions. As an example and not by way of limitation, storage **1106** may include a hard disk drive (HDD), a floppy disk drive, flash memory, an optical disc, a magneto-optical disc, magnetic tape, or a Universal Serial Bus (USB) drive or a combination of two or more of these. Storage **1106** may include removable or non-removable (or fixed) media, where appropriate. Storage **1106** may be internal or external to computer system **1100**, where appropriate. In particular embodiments, storage **1106** is non-volatile, solid-state memory. In particular embodiments, storage **1106** includes read-only memory (ROM). Where appropriate, this ROM may be mask-programmed ROM, programmable ROM (PROM), erasable PROM (EPROM), electrically erasable PROM (EEPROM), electrically alterable ROM (EAROM), or flash memory or a combination of two or more of these. This disclosure contemplates mass storage **1106** taking any suitable physical form. Storage **1106** may include one or more storage control units facilitating communication between processor **1102** and storage **1106**, where appropriate. Where appropriate, storage **1106** may include one or more storages **1106**. Although this disclosure describes and illustrates particular storage, this disclosure contemplates any suitable storage.

(66) In particular embodiments, I/O interface **1108** includes hardware, software, or both, providing one or more interfaces for communication between computer system **1100** and one or more I/O

devices. Computer system **1100** may include one or more of these I/O devices, where appropriate. One or more of these I/O devices may enable communication between a person and computer system **1100**. As an example and not by way of limitation, an I/O device may include a keyboard, keypad, microphone, monitor, mouse, printer, scanner, speaker, still camera, stylus, tablet, touch screen, trackball, video camera, another suitable I/O device or a combination of two or more of these. An I/O device may include one or more sensors. This disclosure contemplates any suitable I/O devices and any suitable I/O interfaces **1108** for them. Where appropriate, I/O interface **1108** may include one or more device or software drivers enabling processor **1102** to drive one or more of these I/O devices. I/O interface **1108** may include one or more I/O interfaces **1108**, where appropriate. Although this disclosure describes and illustrates a particular I/O interface, this disclosure contemplates any suitable I/O interface.

(67) In particular embodiments, communication interface **1110** includes hardware, software, or both providing one or more interfaces for communication (such as, for example, packet-based communication) between computer system **1100** and one or more other computer systems **1100** or one or more networks. As an example and not by way of limitation, communication interface **1110** may include a network interface controller (NIC) or network adapter for communicating with an Ethernet or other wire-based network or a wireless NIC (WNIC) or wireless adapter for communicating with a wireless network, such as a WI-FI network. This disclosure contemplates any suitable network and any suitable communication interface **1110** for it. As an example and not by way of limitation, computer system **1100** may communicate with an ad hoc network, a personal area network (PAN), a local area network (LAN), a wide area network (WAN), a metropolitan area network (MAN), or one or more portions of the Internet or a combination of two or more of these. One or more portions of one or more of these networks may be wired or wireless. As an example, computer system **1100** may communicate with a wireless PAN (WPAN) (such as, for example, a BLUETOOTH WPAN), a WI-FI network, a WI-MAX network, a cellular telephone network (such as, for example, a Global System for Mobile Communications (GSM) network), or other suitable wireless network or a combination of two or more of these. Computer system **1100** may include any suitable communication interface **1110** for any of these networks, where appropriate. Communication interface **1110** may include one or more communication interfaces **1110**, where appropriate. Although this disclosure describes and illustrates a particular communication interface, this disclosure contemplates any suitable communication interface.

(68) In particular embodiments, bus **1112** includes hardware, software, or both coupling components of computer system **1100** to each other. As an example and not by way of limitation, bus **1112** may include an Accelerated Graphics Port (AGP) or other graphics bus, an Enhanced Industry Standard Architecture (EISA) bus, a front-side bus (FSB), a HYPERTRANSPORT (HT) interconnect, an Industry Standard Architecture (ISA) bus, an INFINIBAND interconnect, a low-pin-count (LPC) bus, a memory bus, a Micro Channel Architecture (MCA) bus, a Peripheral Component Interconnect (PCI) bus, a PCI-Express (PCIe) bus, a serial advanced technology attachment (SATA) bus, a Video Electronics Standards Association local (VLB) bus, or another suitable bus or a combination of two or more of these. Bus **1112** may include one or more buses **1112**, where appropriate. Although this disclosure describes and illustrates a particular bus, this disclosure contemplates any suitable bus or interconnect.

(69) Herein, a computer-readable non-transitory storage medium or media may include one or more semiconductor-based or other integrated circuits (ICs) (such as, for example, field-programmable gate arrays (FPGAs) or application-specific ICs (ASICs)), hard disk drives (HDDs), hybrid hard drives (HHDs), optical discs, optical disc drives (ODDs), magneto-optical discs, magneto-optical drives, floppy diskettes, floppy disk drives (FDDs), magnetic tapes, solid-state drives (SSDs), RAM-drives, SECURE DIGITAL cards or drives, any other suitable computer-readable non-transitory storage media, or any suitable combination of two or more of these, where appropriate. A computer-readable non-transitory storage medium may be volatile, non-volatile, or a combination

of volatile and non-volatile, where appropriate.

(70) Herein, “or” is inclusive and not exclusive, unless expressly indicated otherwise or indicated otherwise by context. Therefore, herein, “A or B” means “A, B, or both,” unless expressly indicated otherwise or indicated otherwise by context. Moreover, “and” is both joint and several, unless expressly indicated otherwise or indicated otherwise by context. Therefore, herein, “A and B” means “A and B, jointly or severally,” unless expressly indicated otherwise or indicated otherwise by context.

(71) The scope of this disclosure encompasses all changes, substitutions, variations, alterations, and modifications to the example embodiments described or illustrated herein that a person having ordinary skill in the art would comprehend. The scope of this disclosure is not limited to the example embodiments described or illustrated herein. Moreover, although this disclosure describes and illustrates respective embodiments herein as including particular components, elements, feature, functions, operations, or steps, any of these embodiments may include any combination or permutation of any of the components, elements, features, functions, operations, or steps described or illustrated anywhere herein that a person having ordinary skill in the art would comprehend. Furthermore, reference in the appended claims to an apparatus or system or a component of an apparatus or system being adapted to, arranged to, capable of, configured to, enabled to, operable to, or operative to perform a particular function encompasses that apparatus, system, component, whether or not it or that particular function is activated, turned on, or unlocked, as long as that apparatus, system, or component is so adapted, arranged, capable, configured, enabled, operable, or operative. Additionally, although this disclosure describes or illustrates particular embodiments as providing particular advantages, particular embodiments may provide none, some, or all of these advantages.

Claims

1. A method, by one or more computing systems, the method comprising: providing, for a head-mounted virtual reality (VR) display device and based on a field of view of a user wearing the head-mounted VR display device in a real-world environment, a VR environment comprising, one or more virtual boundaries, corresponding to a real-world environment; determining, based on a position of the user in relation to the one or more virtual boundaries, that a partial passthrough mode should be enabled, wherein the partial passthrough mode provides a partial view of the VR environment and a partial view of the real-world environment; and rendering the partial passthrough mode by performing one or both of: rendering at least a first portion of the partial view of the real-world environment at a first sharpness level and rendering at least a second portion of the partial view of the real-world environment at a second sharpness level lower than the first sharpness level, wherein the first portion of the partial view of the real-world environment is less central to a gaze direction of the user than the second portion of the partial view of the real-world environment; or rendering the partial view of the real-world environment at a size or sharpness level based on a determined position of the user between an inner boundary of the one or more virtual boundaries and an outer boundary of the one or more virtual boundaries.
2. The method of claim 1, wherein the rendering the partial passthrough mode is performed by the rendering at least the first portion of the partial view of the real-world environment at the first sharpness level and the rendering at least the second portion of the partial view of the real-world environment at the second sharpness level lower than the first sharpness level.
3. The method of claim 2, wherein the first sharpness level is achieved by applying blurring or feathering to captured images of the real-world environment provided in the passthrough mode.
4. The method of claim 1, wherein the rendering the partial passthrough mode is performed by the rendering the partial view of the real-world environment at the size or sharpness level based on the determined position of the user between the inner boundary and the outer boundary.

5. The method of claim 4, wherein the rendering the partial view of the real-world environment is at the size based on the determined position of the user between the inner boundary and the outer boundary whereby the size of the partial view of the real-world environment is larger the closer the position of the user is to the outer boundary.
6. The method of claim 4, wherein the rendering the partial view of the real-world environment is at the sharpness based on the determined position of the user between the inner boundary and the outer boundary whereby the sharpness of the partial view of the real-world environment is sharper the closer the position of the user is to the outer boundary.
7. The method of claim 4, wherein the position of the user inner boundary and/or the position of the outer boundary are user-set positions.
8. A non-transitory computer-readable storage medium storing instructions that, when executed by a computing system, cause the computing system to perform a process: providing, for a head-mounted virtual reality (VR) display device and based on a field of view of a user wearing the head-mounted VR display device in a real-world environment, a VR environment comprising, one or more virtual boundaries, corresponding to a real-world environment; determining, based on a position of the user in relation to the one or more virtual boundaries, that a partial passthrough mode should be enabled, wherein the partial passthrough mode provides a partial view of the VR environment and a partial view of the real-world environment; and rendering the partial passthrough mode by performing one or both of: rendering at least a first portion of the partial view of the real-world environment at a first sharpness level and rendering at least a second portion of the partial view of the real-world environment at a second sharpness level lower than the first sharpness level, wherein the first portion of the partial view of the real-world environment is less central to a gaze direction of the user than the second portion of the partial view of the real-world environment; or rendering the partial view of the real-world environment at a size or sharpness level based on a determined position of the user between an inner boundary of the one or more virtual boundaries and an outer boundary of the one or more virtual boundaries.
9. The non-transitory computer-readable storage medium of claim 8, wherein the rendering the partial passthrough mode is performed by the rendering at least the first portion of the partial view of the real-world environment at the first sharpness level and the rendering at least the second portion of the partial view of the real-world environment at the second sharpness level lower than the first sharpness level.
10. The non-transitory computer-readable storage medium of claim 9, wherein the first sharpness level is achieved by applying blurring or feathering to captured images of the real-world environment provided in the passthrough mode.
11. The non-transitory computer-readable storage medium of claim 8, wherein the rendering the partial passthrough mode is performed by the rendering the partial view of the real-world environment at the size or sharpness level based on the determined position of the user between the inner boundary and the outer boundary.
12. The non-transitory computer-readable storage medium of claim 11, wherein the rendering the partial view of the real-world environment is at the size based on the determined position of the user between the inner boundary and the outer boundary whereby the size of the partial view of the real-world environment is larger the closer the position of the user is to the outer boundary.
13. The non-transitory computer-readable storage medium of claim 11, wherein the rendering the partial view of the real-world environment is at the sharpness based on the determined position of the user between the inner boundary and the outer boundary whereby the sharpness of the partial view of the real-world environment is sharper the closer the position of the user is to the outer boundary.
14. The non-transitory computer-readable storage medium of claim 11, wherein the position of the user inner boundary and/or the position of the outer boundary are user-set positions.
15. A computing system comprising: one or more processors; and one or more memories storing

instructions that, when executed by the one or more processors, cause the computing system to perform a process comprising: providing, for a head-mounted virtual reality (VR) display device and based on a field of view of a user wearing the head-mounted VR display device in a real-world environment, a VR environment comprising, one or more virtual boundaries, corresponding to a real-world environment; determining, based on a position of the user in relation to the one or more virtual boundaries, that a partial passthrough mode should be enabled, wherein the partial passthrough mode provides a partial view of the VR environment and a partial view of the real-world environment; and rendering the partial passthrough mode by performing one or both of: rendering at least a first portion of the partial view of the real-world environment at a first sharpness level and rendering at least a second portion of the partial view of the real-world environment at a second sharpness level lower than the first sharpness level, wherein the first portion of the partial view of the real-world environment is less central to a gaze direction of the user than the second portion of the partial view of the real-world environment; or rendering the partial view of the real-world environment at a size or sharpness level based on a determined position of the user between an inner boundary of the one or more virtual boundaries and an outer boundary of the one or more virtual boundaries.

16. The computing system of claim 15, wherein the rendering the partial passthrough mode is performed by the rendering at least the first portion of the partial view of the real-world environment at the first sharpness level and the rendering at least the second portion of the partial view of the real-world environment at the second sharpness level lower than the first sharpness level.

17. The computing system of claim 16, wherein the first sharpness level is achieved by applying blurring or feathering to captured images of the real-world environment provided in the passthrough mode.

18. The computing system of claim 15, wherein the rendering the partial passthrough mode is performed by the rendering the partial view of the real-world environment at the size or sharpness level based on the determined position of the user between the inner boundary and the outer boundary.

19. The computing system of claim 18, wherein the rendering the partial view of the real-world environment is at the size based on the determined position of the user between the inner boundary and the outer boundary whereby the size of the partial view of the real-world environment is larger the closer the position of the user is to the outer boundary.

20. The computing system of claim 18, wherein the rendering the partial view of the real-world environment is at the sharpness based on the determined position of the user between the inner boundary and the outer boundary whereby the sharpness of the partial view of the real-world environment is sharper the closer the position of the user is to the outer boundary.
